

which we will look at in the next section, till then think of it as the device which takes information from your computer and converts it so that it can be sent over the telephone network. This was one of the early methods of connecting to the internet and is still used in some remote places over India. Since it is an old generation technology the transfer speed is also pretty low, typically limited to a maximum of 56 kbit/s. This was more than enough in those times as most webpages back then were text heavy and images were rare. One major drawback with this type was that you could not use your internet connection and the telephone at the same time and if anybody called your line then the connection would disconnect, quite the inconvenience. Also the dial-up tone during the process of making a new connection was pretty iconic.

Multilink dial-up

An improvement of the dial-up, this type of connection used more than one telephone line and combined their individual bandwidth to increase your net internet speed. This still suffered from the troubles with telephone calls where only one service could run at any given time.

LAN

Local area networks (LANs) simply refer to a network of computers over a small area. If you have multiple computers at home accessing the internet then you can establish a LAN within your home. Similarly, schools, colleges, libraries, offices etc provide internet access to computers and other devices via a Local Area Network. LAN can be wired or wireless, wired networks are typically faster as they don't have to deal with interference from the environment. So the average LAN connection has a 100 Mbit/s upper limit, when you are connected to the internet and you move the mouse over the internet icon in the taskbar you'll see '10/100Mbit', this is the maximum speed that can be attained via your hardware but that does not mean that you'll get that speed over the internet as this speed is dependent on all the intermediate hardware between your computer and your ISP. Also, your speed might be limited to ensure everybody on the network gets uniform access to the internet as a 'Fair Usage Policy'. However, the 100 Mbit/s speed can be easily achieved over the LAN when sharing between computers which are members of the same network. Even then you might not achieve the speed because your hard drive simply cannot cope with such high speeds but if you have an SSD